BUSINESS PROPOSAL

UMHackathon 2026

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1. Executive Summary:

GigHub is an AI-governed escrow marketplace designed to bridge the "trust and infrastructure deficit" in Malaysia's gig economy. Our market target 1.64 million gig workers and 1.07 million SMEs, GigHub professionalizes independent labor by linking clear project requirements to guaranteed payments. The platform's core purpose is to protect freelancers from non-payment and "ghosting" while providing SMEs with a digital HR safety net that ensures quality and protects intellectual property. By translating informal transactions into bank-verifiable "Statements of Earnings," GigHub solves the "unbankable" status of gig workers under the Gig Workers Act 2025, unlocking access to housing and automotive loans. The competitive advantage is GigHub is an AI-governed machine that professionalizes the Malaysian gig economy by mandating contract specificity and transforming informal project data into bank-verifiable income history. The business model generates revenue through platform fees charged in successful transactions of work and payment.

2. Product Overview / Solution

Key Features:

- **Brief Builder + GLM Validation:** Companies complete a structured brief form. GLM-4 scores specificity and wage/complexity reasonableness (0–100). A brief must score ≥70 before it is published and escrow can be funded — preventing unenforceable contracts at source.

- **Smart AI Matchmaking:** Two-way GLM-powered matching. Freelancers receive a personalised job feed ranked by skill fit and past GLM submission score history. Companies receive a shortlist of the most qualified freelancers for each posted brief.

- **Freelancer Acceptance + Escrow Trigger:** Freelancer accepts → company funds escrow before work begins. This sequence guarantees no freelancer starts work without confirmed payment, and no company is locked in before a match exists.

- **Milestone System with Auto-Release:** Up to 5 milestones per project. 50/50 split option available. 72-hour auto-release if client is unresponsive — eliminates ghosting. Watermarked previews for design deliverables prevent IP theft before payment.

- **Income Intelligence Dashboard:** GLM analyses completed project history to generate monthly earnings summaries, market rate benchmarks by skill and sector, and a formal

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PDF income statement accepted for Malaysian bank loan and mortgage applications — directly addressing gig workers' 'unbankable' status under the Gig Workers Act 2025.

- **E2E Encrypted Delivery:** All deliverables encrypted client-side (AES-256-GCM) before upload. GigHub servers never hold decryptable content. Files hard-deleted from Cloudflare R2 after 72 hours. SHA-256 hash permanently stored as proof-of-delivery.

Technology Used:

- **Full-Stack Web Platform:** Next.js 14 — full-stack React web application, mobile-responsive, deployed on Vercel. Node.js + Express REST API for escrow state machine, GLM orchestration, file metadata extraction, and payment webhooks.

- **ZhipuAI GLM-4. (Decision Intelligence):** ZhipuAI GLM-4 API handles brief validation, job matchmaking, income intelligence, and dispute analysis. Assembled server-side only — API key never exposed to client. Responses cached in Redis (24hr TTL) for cost and latency efficiency.

- **Data Infrastructure:** PostgreSQL (append-only escrow ledger for immutable audit trail), Redis (escrow race-condition lock, session management, GLM response cache), Cloudflare R2 (zero-egress file storage with 72hr lifecycle delete rule).

- **Payments & Compliance:** Stripe sandbox for hackathon demo; iPay88 / FPX for production Malaysian banking. PCI-DSS compliant by delegation — card data never stored on GigHub servers. PDPA-compliant data handling throughout.

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3. Market Research & Market Dynamics

3.1 Problem Landscape

Malaysian gig workers contribute around 25% to national GDP but face 72% institutional financial exclusion because traditional banks reject informal income records. They face high payment uncertainty and lack of formal banking documentation leading to the “unbankable” status where they are unable to secure housing and automotive loans. Simultaneously, 1.07 million SMEs are hesitant to hire freelancers due to operational risks like "talent ghosting," scope creep, and intellectual property exposure. GigHub is designed to be the safety net for both freelancers and SMEs.

3.2 Market Niche

GigHub targets two distinct user segments. Supply side: Malaysian digital freelancers — specifically designers, copywriters, developers, and translators — earning RM 2,000–8,000/month from project work, who have been unable to access credit despite consistent income. Demand side: Malaysian SMEs, startups, and marketing agencies requiring specialist project-based talent without full-time HR infrastructure. Typical company project budget: RM 500–20,000 per engagement.

The secondary target is Malaysian youth (18–28) entering freelancing as a primary career path under 10.1% youth unemployment conditions — who need income credibility to access financial products as they build their careers. GigHub's income statement is their first formal financial document.

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3.3 Market Sizing

Market Tier	Definition	Estimated Value (2026)
TAM	Southeast Asia Countries	RM 35.0 billion
SAM	Malaysian Professional Gig Market	RM 5.8 billion
SOM	Realistic market capture (18 Months) - 2% of SAM	RM 116 million

3.4 Market Dynamics & Placement:

- **Gig Workers Act 2025:** New legal requirements for contract transparency and dispute mechanisms create an immediate need for GigHub's automated compliance.

- **Youth Unemployment (10.1%):** High unemployment drives the shift toward autonomous, professional gig work as a career path. GigHub aims to

- **Digitalization of Banking:** Malaysian banks are increasingly open to alternative data for credit scoring if it is verified and structured.

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4. Value Proposition & Competitive Advantage

GigHub is the only platform where GLM-4 functions as a financial controller. Unlike our competitors, we provide an "Income Intelligence" transcript specifically mapped to the Malaysian banking sector, turning volatile work into a bankable asset. Our E2E encryption architecture ensures that even in the event of a platform breach, data remains an unreadable "opaque blob".

Also, GigHub's core financial state machine is the AI, which differs with competitors where AI is literally an "add-on". GigHub ensures every job posted meets a quality threshold (>=70 score) before funds can move.

GigHub has the competitive advantage as being the first to provide payment security for freelancers and guaranteed outcome for SMEs, bridging the trust gap between two parties.

5. Competitor Analysis (Porter's Five Forces)

Force	Intensity	Assessment
Competitive Rivalry	Medium	• Competitors like GoGet exist but they prioritize on-site jobs.
Threat of New Entrants	Low	• High barrier due to the complexity of the AI-governed escrow state-machine and encryption.
Bargaining Power of Buyers	Medium	• SMEs value the risk reduction; switching cost is high due to the verified "Match Score."

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Bargaining Power of Suppliers	High	• Freelancers prefer platforms that offer the highest bid.
Threat of Substitutes	Low	• Manual contracts and bank transfers provide zero protection against freelancers or SMEs

Competitor Comparison Table:

Competitor	Strength	Weakness	GigHub's Advantage
GoGet	It already has a presence in the current market.	Focuses mainly on on-site job	Bridge gap between digital freelancers and SMEs
Upwork	It is a Global established brand.	On Upwork, escrow release is often at the client's discretion, which can lead to payment delays or "hostage" situations if a client is unresponsive.	GigHub uses GLM-4 to score project briefs. Jobs are only published if they score ≥ 70, ensuring contracts are clearly defined and enforceable from day one.

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6. Business Model Canvas

6.1. Customer Segmentation

- **Professional Freelancers:** Those seeking bank-ready PDF income statements for mortgages.
- **SMEs & Startups:** Companies requiring high-fidelity delivery without administrative friction, requiring a guarantee that funds are only released upon quality delivery.

6.2. Revenue Stream

Primary: Escrow-as-a-Service. Platform fee will be automatically deducted upon successful escrow release. A two tier fee is applied: 8% for projects < RM 5,000 and 5% for projects > RM 5,000

Secondary: GigHub Pro subscription for freelancers to unlock prioritised AI-matchmaking and unlimited income statement generation. Priced at RM 30/month.

Tertiary: Company pays advertising fee to have high-visibility placement for SME branding and hiring. Priced at RM 2,000/month.

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6.3. Cost Structure

Cost Drivers	Cost Type
• **Infrastructure:** Vercel hosting, PostgreSQL (Supabase/Neon), and Redis cache management.	Fixed Cost
• **AI Operations:** GLM-4 API token consumption for contract orchestration and project scoring.	Variable Cost
• **Security & Compliance:** Regular penetration testing and AES-256-GCM encryption audit maintenance.	Overhead Cost

6.4. Key Partners

Internal	External
Development Team: Full-stack engineers managing the Next.js/Node.js ecosystem.	**ZhipuAI:** Providing the GLM-4 model core for the orchestrator.
QA/DevOps: Managing CI/CD pipelines and the 85% test pass rate threshold.	**Payment Gateways:** (e.g., ToyyibPay/Stripe) for local FPX and card processing.

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6.5 Risk Assessment

Risk Type	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
AI Hallucination	High	Low	Human-moderated dispute path; AI only scores "specificity".
Regulatory	High	Medium	Position as a data verification tool, not a financial bank.
GLM Latency	Medium	High	Redis caching for brief scores and asynchronous PDF generation.

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7. Implementation & Financials

7.1 Go-to-Market Strategy

GigHub will follow a **"Talent-First"** rollout. Initially, we will partner with local SMEs to post quality jobs with lucrative and attractive wages to attract high-quality freelancers onboard. This creates a supply of verified talent that attracts SMEs looking for cost-effective, high-quality technical work. Eventually, through expansion it aims to reach a broader market throughout the Southeast Asia region.

7.2 Implementation Plan

Phase	Action	Timeline	Target
Soft Launch	Pilot with 50 local SMEs within Klang Valley and prioritising UM Alumni	Month 1-4	1,000 Validated Briefs
Expansion Phase	Nationwide SME Onboarding	4-12 Months	3,000 Active Freelancers
Integration	Direct API connection for Bank Loan Verification	Month 12-18	RM 20M in verified income statements
TOTAL	RM 7.6M investment	18 Months	Significant Market Share (≥55%)

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7.3 Revenue Projections

Metric	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Active Users	3,000	12,500	45,000
Total Transaction Value (GMV)	RM 18.0M	RM 116M	RM 417.6M
Escrow Revenue (6% avg)	RM 1.08M	RM 6.96M	RM 25.06M
Subscription Revenue	RM 104,400	RM 675,000	RM 3.24M
Total Revenue	RM 1.18M	RM 7.64M	RM 26.62M
Net Position	RM (6.22M)	RM 50,000	RM 13.80M

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7.4 Key Financial Milestones

- **Month 1-4:** Achieve **1,000 validated briefs** and jobs during the soft launch phase.
- **Month 4-12:** Expand from initial pilot cities to cover a network of 700 partner vendors and 17,100 daily orders across major Malaysian hubs like Penang and Johor.
- **Month 18-30:**
    - **Break-Even Point:** Reach the break-even milestone by Month 18, transitioning from a negative net position to a positive contribution margin.
    - **Financial Growth:** Projecting a Year 3 total revenue of RM 17.82M with a net positive position of RM 10.52M.
    - **Market Share:** Capture SOM (Serviceable Obtainable Market), a significant 2% market share of the professional digital gig economy in Malaysia.
    - **Cashflow Maturity:** Achieve a consistently positive cashflow by Month 30, triggering a feasibility review for regional expansion into Southeast Asia.
- **Month 30:**
    - Cashflow positive; feasibility review for expansion.

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